

Malik Zhang

Product Designer

Designing products that bridge human needs and digital possibilities.

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EXPERIENCE

Capstone Project Sponsored by Apple

New Paradigm for XR Text Input

Designed a new interaction paradigm for text input in XR, rethinking current high-friction methods through faster, multimodal alternatives.

- Identified text input as XR's highest-friction task through a competitive teardown of 4 input methods
- Observed 8 Vision Pro and Quest users and ran interviews to map real-world friction patterns
- Prototyped 3 interaction concepts in Xcode, converging on a multimodal model that pairs predictive AI with gaze-led targeting
- Validated the model with 10 users in usability testing, [outcome]

Product Designer

Jan 2026–Present
Seattle, WA

NeuraLyfe

FigBuild 2026 — 1st Place out of 690

Designed a sideline decision-support system that translates helmet impact data into actionable neurological risk insights for medical staff.

- Designed three views to scan team risk, investigate brain status, and replay the flagged impact
- Prototyped real-time risk monitoring and impact analysis in Figma Make
- Translated neurological data into clear sideline decision signals

Product Designer

Mar 2026
Seattle, WA

Aura

Motion Sickness Relief System

Designed an AI-powered wearable system that proactively reduces motion sickness through anticipatory sensory feedback.

- Designed an AI wearable for proactive motion sickness relief
- Designed real-time sensing and adaptive feedback loop
- Framed anticipatory care as a new paradigm in mobility experiences
- Demonstrated feasibility of sensory intervention in mobility scenarios

Product + ID

Sep–Dec 2025
Seattle, WA

Mood Muse

Communication Aid for Autistic Children

Designed a communication aid that helps autistic children express emotions through color-based interaction.

- Translated physiological signals into color for nonverbal expression
- Applied art therapy principles to support emotional communication
- Helped externalize internal emotional states through accessible cues
- Prototyped with Rhino, Keyshot, Arduino, Processing, and FDM printing

Product + ID

Aug–Dec 2024
Hangzhou, China

WORK

UW MHCI+D

Technology and Equipment Manager

- Designed an online inventory system to streamline access to equipment
- Supported prototyping and equipment access for student design work
- Maintained studio technology operations for project development

Sep 2025–Present

Seattle, WA

IKEA

UX Designer Intern

- Contributed to UX design work for retail and service experiences
- Supported research and concept development across user-centered initiatives

Mar–Aug 2025

Hangzhou, China

Focused Photonics Inc.

Product Designer Intern

- Contributed to form and interaction design for monitoring devices
- Translated technical requirements into usable product concepts

Jun–Sep 2024

Hangzhou, China

EDUCATION

University of Washington

Master of Human Computer
Interaction + Design
2025–2026
Seattle, WA

Zhejiang University of

Technology

B.E., Industrial Design
2021–2025
Hangzhou, China

SKILLS

Design

System Thinking, Ideation
Information Architecture
Concept Development
Design Strategy
Rapid Prototyping
Wearable Design
Vibe Coding

Research

User Interviews, Surveys
Journey Map, Personas
Archetype, Affinity Map
Storyboarding, User Flows
Competitive Analysis
Qualitative Research
Heuristic Evaluation
Usability Testing
A/B Testing

Tools

Figma, Photoshop, After
Effects, Premiere Pro
Cursor, Claude Code
Unity, Xcode
Rhino, Keyshot
Arduino, FDM Printing